

GHOST OF NEW YEAR'S RESOLUTIONS

POLITICS

Dear Osagyefo, As the calendar flips once more and we stand at the threshold of another year, I find myself reaching back through the fog of time to speak with you. We are currently in that strange, transitional season where the Republic is filled with "New Year, New Me" declarations. We write down resolutions with the fervor of a prophet, promising to turn a new leaf, to conquer the gym, and to save every pesewa. Yet, as surely as the sun rises, we know the truth: by the second week of January, those resolutions will be buried under the weight of reality, and that "new leaf" will look suspiciously like the old one we tried to discard.

But we must face the hard truth, Osagyefo: change will not happen unless we change our ways. We look to the Jubilee House for a "Reset," but we refuse to reset our own hearts. We complain about the state of the nation while throwing litter into the gutters; we cry about corruption while seeking "whom we know" to bypass the queue. We want a new Ghana, but we are holding tightly to the old, selfish habits that brought us here. A new year is just a change of date; a new life requires a change of direction.

I miss the quiet dignity of the good old days. The New Year's Eve services of our youth. We went to church to seek the face of the Creator, not to hear a theatrical performance. We closed early, walking home under the stars with a simple sense of peace. There were no "Watch Night" spectacles filled with doom-laden prophecies or competitive predictions about which celebrity might fall. The altars were for prayer, not for political commentary or sensationalism.

In those days, the church was the star of the show, not the man behind the pulpit. If you walked through the neighborhood, you would see a simple wooden signpost with an arrow pointing the way to the sanctuary. Today, those signposts have been replaced by towering, glossy billboards featuring the "Man of God" in a three-piece suit, looking more like a corporate CEO than a humble servant. We have traded the direction to the Cross for a map to a personality.

And what of the Harmattan? The January winds still blow, but they felt different then. I remember the sharp, biting chill of the early morning air that made us shiver even under heavy cloth. We walked to school with our feet and shins turned a ghostly white, the "ashy" badge of honor that no amount of pomade or Shea butter could truly defeat. We would spend half the morning trying to hide our cracked heels, a testament to the dry, dusty breath of the Sahara. The air back then carried more than just dust; it carried the aroma of the season. The scent of the Christmas stew? It was a distinct, rich perfume that hung over the entire neighborhood. You didn't need to be invited to a house to know what was cooking. The combination of slow-simmered tomatoes, ginger, and fried meat created a fragrance so potent it seemed to weave through the narrow alleys and over compound walls. Now, as we struggle to keep goals that melt away before the Harmattan even clears, I find myself wishing we could return to that simplicity. We are so busy chasing the "new" that we have forgotten the beauty of the "old" the peace of a silent night, the humility of a simple signpost, and the honest, ashy

reality of a January morning. We pray for a better year, but perhaps we should pray for better versions of ourselves. So Long, Ato KD